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ASUS ROG STRIX RX 6600 XT OC 8GB Graphics Card

Great gen-on-gen upgrade



Price
₹37,748

It's been nearly a year since AMD came out with their RDNA 2 microarchitecture for GPUs which have been powering their RX 6000 series cards. They've finally released a mid-range graphics card which is supposed to go up against NVIDIA's RTX 3060 and 3060 Ti. While AMD did quote an MSRP of 379 dollars for the RX 6600 XT, the reality is that AIB cards such as the one we have here cost a heck of lot more. In fact, if you scour the web for a 6600 XT online, you'll end up with retail listings that start around 61 thousand rupees. AMD is positioning the RX 6600 XT for 1080p and 1440p gaming.

PERFORMANCE

The AMD Radeon RX 6600 XT scores 10,280 in TimeSpy which puts it a little behind the RX 6700 XT's 11,416. Similarly, in Fire Strike Ultra, the 6600 XT scores a little over 1600 points lower than the RX 6700 XT. The two cards are leagues apart in terms of performance in the synthetic benchmarks. OpenGL performance has improved though, the 6600 XT actually scores more than the RX 6700 XT but there are not that many games leveraging OpenGL in Windows. Coming to gaming, we see the RX 6600 XT score 173 FPS in Battlefield V, 90 in Borderlands 3, 133 in Death Stranding, 202 in Doom Eternal, 110 in Metro Exodus without ray tracing, and 140 in Shadow of the Tomb Raider. All of these numbers were at 1080p. It's when we switch to 1440p or 4K that we see the relative positioning of the cards change by a few steps. At 1080p, the RX 6600 XT can be said to perform 10 FPS higher than the RX 5700 XT, at 1440p that difference comes down to 2 FPS and at 4K, the 5700 XT performs better by about 2 FPS. Same happens

when you compare it with the RTX 3060, except the RTX 3060 starts out with a much wider performance gap at 1080p and equals the 6600 XT at 4K. The reduced infinity cache on the RX 6600 XT could be why this is happening.

RAY TRACING

RDNA 2 based AMD cards, being the company's first to incorporate dedicated ray-tracing hardware, are still behind NVIDIA's RTX 30-series cards. The ASUS ROG STRIX RX 6600 XT OC isn't at the bottom of the pack but it's still down there. The only card it beats in our list is the RTX 2060. But these are synthetic benchmarks, during actual gameplay the RX 6600 XT equals the RTX 2070 at 1080p in some games but when you move to 1440p or 4K, then the RX 6600 XT falls back into place above the RTX 2060.

POWER CONSUMPTION AND THERMALS

AMD's cards have been improving quite a bit over the years in terms of power consumption. The RX 6600 XT idles at around 4-5 W and during gaming can teeter around 170 W. This is in line with the competing NVIDIA cards.

VERDICT

The RX 6600 XT performs better than the RTX 3060 at 1080p by a margin



FEATURES.....	80
PERFORMANCE.....	68
VALUE.....	75
DESIGN.....	77

of 12-14 per cent, as long as you're playing games that don't have ray-tracing. Ray tracing considered, the RX 6600 XT is easily beaten by the RTX 3060 in video games and in synthetic benchmarks, the performance is nearly half of RTX 3060. The RX

6600 XT retains its lead over the RTX 3060 when you're gaming at 1080p and 1440p but on 4K, the two cards are very similar in performance. Then again, AMD's marketing clearly pegs the 6600 XT as a 1080p and 1440p graphics card. That aside, if we're to compare the RX 6600 XT with its RDNA 1 counterpart, the RX 5600 XT, then we see a massive improvement gen-on-gen. That itself should be enough to warrant an upgrade. Pricing for the RX 6600 XT is completely out of whack like all other graphics cards. You can get AIB cards starting from 61 thousand rupees which is a little higher than what you might pay for the RTX 3060. It might be a few months before GPU prices normalise so if you're looking to buy a graphics card, the RX 6600 XT is a pretty great option.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

STREAM PROCESSORS: 2048 | CU: 32 | BOOST CLOCK: 2607 MHz | VRAM: 8 GB GDDR6 | BUS-WIDTH: 128-bit | CONNECTORS: 1x 8-PIN | TBP: 230W

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